Diversity Statement

Jane Hsieh

In my vision of a computing utopia, technological advancements should broaden opportunities to access and education. Transformative technologies should include, reach and elevate wider segments of society, enabling more pluralistic values and voices while breaking barriers to access participation and collaboration. Throughout my graduate journey, I served on a multitude of committees in various volunteer-based roles to pursue this objective, and hope to continue many of these initiatives at the University of Washington's iSchool.

My own research journey began as a STRONG scholar – a pre-college program aimed at introducing traditionally underrepresented and recently admitted students to research opportunities. Together with this cohort of highly diverse, supportive and intellectually engaged cohort of peers, I learned about Carol Dweck's Growth Mindset, grappled with effectively reading papers, practiced collaboratively generating and communicating research ideas. This experience was nothing short of transformative and jumpstarted my career as a budding researcher. Today I continue to draw on these perspectives gained at STRONG and am committed to sharing such ways of thinking with my own colleagues, as well as incoming generations of students and researchers.

My service commitments put these inclusive values to practice: I co-organized (1) large-scale speed-dating sessions with the Dean's PhD Advisory Working Group for Undergraduate Research Engagement to connect aspiring undergraduate researchers with potential mentors (2) coordinated matchings that connected PhD applicants across institutions with existing doctoral students as a part of CMU's graduate application support program – helping them demystify the hidden curriculum behind the process – and (3) cross-department lunches as a part of Women @ SCS initiative to connect graduate and postdoctoral gender minorities in computing. As a faculty member, I am eager to actively support, expand or create similar opportunities for fostering caring and inclusive academic communities.

In my teaching, I create a variety of channels to encourage student engagement regardless of their style of learning – including Slack and Piazza workspaces, a multitude of channels for feedback (*e.g.*, GitHub, Gradescope, Canvas). These mechanisms are my attempts to curb the inevitable Matthew effect where high achieving and confident students disproportionately engage with and benefit from available resources. In the course *Introduction to Software Construction* where students are known to struggle with core concepts, I make sure to provide ample opportunities for one-on-one engagement during class and at office hours, where I distribute effort on a need basis – *i.e.,* providing more focused and targeted feedback that personalizes to each students' style of learning. For instance, some studies require step-by-step guidance with questions while others simply need an active listener of their thoughts and ideas.

At CMU, I was incredibly fortunate to take part in an immensely supportive and diverse computing community. Despite the regular, ongoing and endless forces that uplift us, the marginality of our identities continue to strike at us. Incredibly, many of these efforts and endeavors to empower computing students (and communities impacted by technologies) remain ongoing efforts, despite oppositional sociopolitical forces. As organizations and communities continually shift and reshape itself, I am committed to finding novel ways of propelling the next generations of vulnerable students and workers towards more liberated and **thriving** careers.

As an active member of my research community, I currently serve as an associate chair for the *Interactions Beyond the Individual* subcommittee of CHI (ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems), where I was previously an assistant to the subcommittee chairs three years back. Last year, I served both as a member of (1) the tenure-track search committee for my department (Software and Societal Systems, or S3D for short) as well as a student representative on the (2) committee for student teaching awards at the School of Computer Science. As a reviewer, I served on the panel for REU admissions in my own department (2021-2025) as well as at the Human Computer Interaction Institute (2023). With the exception of 2023 (where I served as a subcommittee chair assistant), I reviewed papers yearly for CHI since 2020, and for CHIWORK since 2023. In even earlier stages of my graduate career, I was a student volunteer at the ACM conferences of CHI, DIS and UIST in 2023.

I understand that the path to more inclusive and empowering academic communities requires gradual but sustained and dynamic efforts. I am committed to supporting the building and growth of individuals, relationships and communities as we evolve together in fast-changing landscapes.